Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report

Beechwood Court

Beechwood College, Beechwood House, Hayes Road, Penarth, CF64 5SE

02920532210

https://www.iriscaregroup.co.uk/beechwood-college

The inspection visits for this service took place between 24/09/2026 and 05/10/2026

Service Information:

Operated by:	Beechwood Court Limited
Care Type:	Care Home Service Adults Without Nursing
Provision for:	Care and support for with mental health needs, Care and support for younger adults with some children (up to 25), Care and support for with a learning disability
Registered places:	57
Main language(s):	English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The provider promotes, anticipates, identifies, and meets the Welsh language and culture needs of people.

Ratings:

Well-being	Excellent
Care & Support	Excellent
Environment	Good
Leadership & Management	Excellent

Summary:

Beechwood Court is a care home service providing residential care, support and specialist education for adults with learning disabilities, autism, mental health needs, acquired brain injuries and epilepsy. The service is comprised of six homes and delivers personalised education, independent living skills and work-related learning opportunities alongside residential care, supporting people to develop independence, participate in their communities and achieve their personal outcomes through a person-centred approach.

People achieve excellent well-being outcomes because they are supported to make choices, maintain relationships, access healthcare, participate in education and engage in meaningful community activities. Strong advocacy arrangements, excellent health support, positive family involvement and a wide range of social opportunities enable people to develop independence, achieve personal goals and enjoy fulfilling lives.

People receive excellent care and support that is personalised, responsive and based on detailed assessments of their needs and aspirations. Strong multidisciplinary working, effective communication support, robust behaviour support planning and safe medication management ensure people receive consistent support that promotes independence, safety and positive outcomes across all aspects of their lives.

The environment is good and largely supports people's independence, well-being and daily routines. Personalised bedrooms, welcoming communal spaces and extensive outdoor facilities contribute to positive outcomes and enhance people's quality of life. However, improvements are required to ensure maintenance issues in some areas are addressed in a timely manner and are consistently maintained to a good standard. This will help ensure people continue to experience safe, comfortable and well-maintained environments that fully support their well-being outcomes. The provider has recognised these areas for improvement and has developed action plans to address them.

People benefit from excellent leadership and management arrangements that promote a positive culture, effective governance and continuous improvement. Leaders are visible, knowledgeable and committed to high-quality care. Care staff feel valued and supported, families express high levels of confidence in the service, and robust quality assurance systems help drive positive outcomes for people.

Findings:

Well-being — Excellent

People experience exceptionally positive well-being outcomes because they are supported by a highly committed care staff team who place their rights, aspirations, health and happiness at the centre of daily practice. People have strong opportunities to exercise choice and control over their lives and are actively involved in decisions about their futures.

People achieve excellent outcomes in relation to their physical health, emotional well-being and independence. Robust healthcare arrangements ensure people receive timely access to GPs, dentists, opticians, podiatry services and specialist clinicians. A dedicated health and well-being coordinator supports people to attend appointments and access specialist interventions. We found care staff are strong advocates for people's health and well-being. They work effectively with healthcare professionals to promote positive outcomes and provide sensitive, compassionate support to people when they experience changes in their health or circumstances. One family member stated*, 'Beechwood college have gone above and beyond for our son and ourselves'*, whilst another reported, '*Our son's physical and mental well-being is optimal thanks to the very good care.'*

People are supported to develop meaningful relationships and participate fully in community life. People access a wide range of educational, recreational and employment opportunities, including work experience placements, volunteering, community activities, holidays and cultural visits. We saw evidence of activities including bowling, museums, beach visits, Cardiff Bay, St Fagans, dog therapy and beauty sessions. Innovative work experience opportunities, such as supporting stock rotation and customer service within the onsite shop, help people develop valuable skills for when they finish college. Feedback from people was overwhelmingly positive. One person stated, '*I have fun at Beechwood'* and '*I love my college, I have lost weight, I am happy.'* During inspection we observed warm, respectful interactions between people and care staff, with people appearing relaxed, engaged and confident.

People feel safe and benefit from strong safeguarding arrangements. 'Student voice' is embedded through reviews, forums, key worker sessions and daily practice, ensuring people are listened to and can influence decisions about their lives. Families consistently praised the support provided, with one relative describing the care as '*above and beyond what you expect'* and another stating, *"Basically everything!"* when asked what the service does well. These exceptional outcomes demonstrate a service that consistently promotes and enhances 's well-being and supports people to achieve their full potential through person-centred, compassionate and highly effective care and support.

The service promotes 's rights through a Welsh Active Offer, including Welsh-speaking care staff, bilingual resources, cultural celebrations and opportunities to experience Welsh heritage.

Care & Support — Excellent

People receive exceptionally high-quality, personalised care and support which is designed around their strengths, aspirations, preferences and individual needs. Comprehensive assessments are undertaken before admission to ensure the service is suitable and that people receive the right support from the outset. Information gathered from families, professionals and multidisciplinary teams informs detailed support arrangements which are regularly reviewed to ensure they remain responsive to changing circumstances and outcomes.

Care records demonstrate an excellent understanding of people as individuals. Personal plans are person-centred, outcome-focused and provide clear guidance to care staff on how to support people consistently. Plans reflect people's routines, preferences, communication methods, goals and aspirations, helping ensure care is delivered in a way that promotes dignity, choice and independence. We saw strong evidence that people, their families and professionals contribute to care planning and review processes, ensuring support remains meaningful and relevant.

The service benefits from highly effective multidisciplinary working arrangements. Residential, education, behavioural support, therapy and clinical teams work closely together to review progress and respond promptly to changes in need. Six-weekly multidisciplinary reviews provide valuable opportunities to evaluate support arrangements, identify emerging trends and agree actions to improve outcomes. This collaborative approach helps ensure people receive seamless support and benefit from consistent practice across all areas of the service.

Communication support is a particular strength. People are provided with personalised communication passports, social stories, visual tools and specialist speech and language therapy support where required. Care staff demonstrate a good understanding of individual communication needs and adapt their approach accordingly. This helps people express their wishes, make choices and participate in decisions which affect their lives. We saw excellent examples of personalised resources being used to reduce anxiety, improve understanding and promote engagement.

Positive Behaviour Support arrangements are comprehensive and informed by specialist clinical input. Detailed plans provide care staff with clear guidance regarding proactive, preventative and responsive strategies. These plans are regularly reviewed and include personalised information about triggers, communication styles and effective interventions. Risk assessments are thorough and promote positive risk-taking whilst ensuring people's safety and well-being. Care staff have access to clear, detailed guidance which supports them to respond consistently and confidently to complex situations.

Medication management arrangements were found to be robust. Medication administration records were accurate, audits were completed regularly and protocols were in place to support safe administration, monitoring and review. Records demonstrated clear oversight and evidence of

learning when issues had arisen.

Environment — Good

People live in environments that generally support their well-being, independence and day-to-day needs. Accommodation is spread across a range of houses and self-contained flats, providing opportunities for people to develop independence and prepare for the future after college. Bedrooms are personalised and reflect people's individual interests, hobbies and preferences through the use of photographs, personal possessions, sensory items and decorations. We saw examples of bedrooms personalised to meet specific needs, helping people feel comfortable and secure within their home environments.

The service benefits from extensive outdoor facilities which provide meaningful opportunities for recreation, exercise and social engagement. People have access to gardens, accessible pathways, swings, football goals, trampolines, sensory spaces and other outdoor areas. These spaces are generally well maintained and encourage people to spend time outdoors, develop social skills and participate in activities which support their well-being. The grounds also include facilities that enable people to engage in work experience opportunities and spaces which promote both student and staff well-being.

Communal areas are generally comfortable, welcoming and suitable for their intended purpose. During the inspection we observed people relaxing in living rooms, listening to music, spending time with their peers and accessing sensory facilities. Several homes have benefited from refurbishment works, including modernised bathroom facilities and well-maintained communal spaces. The self-contained flats provide a particularly positive environment for developing independent living skills, with suitable kitchen and living facilities that enable people to practise everyday tasks and prepare for the next stages of their lives.

The provider has systems in place to monitor the condition of the environment and identify required maintenance works. Environmental audits, maintenance logs and refurbishment plans provide oversight of the premises and demonstrate a commitment to ongoing investment. We found evidence of planned improvement works and agreements for significant refurbishment projects, including replacement fire doors and repairs to areas affected by water damage. The provider had responded positively to concerns raised by external agencies and had developed action plans to address identified issues.

However, improvements are required to ensure all areas of the environment consistently meet the standard expected. During our inspection of one of the homes, we identified maintenance issues including water damage, mould around a bath, damaged flooring, peeling paintwork, damaged furnishings and some bedrooms without appropriate window coverings. While many of these issues had been reported and plans were in place to address them, they had not always been resolved

within reasonable timescales.

Leadership & Management — Excellent

People benefit from a service that is led by a strong, experienced and visible leadership team which is committed to delivering high-quality, person-centred care and support. The Responsible Individual (RI) and managers demonstrate a detailed understanding of the people using the service and maintain a clear focus on achieving positive outcomes. Throughout the inspection, we found evidence of a positive culture where people, families and care staff are valued, listened to and encouraged to contribute to the ongoing development of the service.

Governance arrangements are comprehensive and provide effective oversight of the quality and safety of care. Regular audits, quality and safety meetings, multidisciplinary reviews, provider assessments and RI visits are used to monitor performance and identify areas for development. Managers respond appropriately to incidents, complaints and concerns through detailed investigations, reflective practice and action planning. The service demonstrates a willingness to learn and make improvements, promoting accountability and continuous development across all areas of practice.

Workforce development is a significant strength. Care staff benefit from structured induction programmes, competency frameworks, supervision, appraisals and access to a broad range of training opportunities. We found strong compliance with mandatory training requirements and evidence of ongoing professional development opportunities for care staff at all levels. Innovative arrangements are in place to support internationally recruited care staff, helping them to settle into both their roles and life within Wales. Care staff described the organisation as supportive and committed to their development.

Care staff consistently spoke positively about the leadership and support available to them. One care staff member stated, "*I would recommend working at BWC (Beechwood Court) because of the supportive and approachable management team, the dedication and teamwork demonstrated by staff, and the opportunities available for personal and professional development."* Another told us, *"Overall, I am proud to be part of the service. There is a strong commitment to providing high-quality, person-centred support, and staff work hard to ensure individuals are safe, happy, and supported to achieve their goals."* During discussions, care staff described managers as approachable, visible and responsive, and reported feeling valued and supported within their roles.

The service promotes a positive workplace culture which supports care staff well-being and retention. Care staff described strong peer support, meaningful supervision arrangements and opportunities for career progression. We saw additional initiatives to support staff welfare, including a staff food bank, recognition awards and dedicated spaces for prayer and reflection. Team meetings are regular, detailed and demonstrate meaningful engagement, with care staff

contributing ideas and influencing practice development.

Feedback from families is exceptionally positive and reflected confidence in the leadership arrangements. One family member informed us, '*The way the college work with him and support him to achieve his goals is very pleasing.'* Another stated, *"The care that my son receives is above and beyond what you expect."* We also received feedback praising communication, consistency of support and the commitment shown by the RI and management during both routine and challenging circumstances.

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

The table(s) below show the area(s) for priority action and/or those for improvement we have identified.

Summary of Areas for Improvement	Date identified
People may not achieve the best possible outcomes because environmental improvements and maintenance issues are not always addressed promptly, resulting in some areas of the service falling below the standard expected for people's comfort, privacy, dignity and well-being.	23/09/26

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

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